

Absolutely — **bun** is a useful polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “At first, I just went in for a quick coffee and a **bun**...”

Here **bun** means **a small individual bread roll or sweet bread item**. But the word also has common meanings involving **hairstyles**, and a few useful compounds such as **hamburger bun** and **hot dog bun**.

Word family: **bun**

Base word: bun

Plural: buns

Part of speech: noun (名詞)

Meaning in your passage: **bun** = small bread roll / small sweet bread — 小麵包；圓麵包

Your sentence:

> “I just went in for a quick coffee and a **bun**.”

Here **bun** means:

> **a small individual bread item, often round and sometimes sweet or filled.**

繁體中文：

一個小型、通常圓形的麵包，可能是原味、甜味或有餡；小麵包 / 圓麵包

Natural translation:

> “I just went in for a quick coffee and a bun.”

「我只是進去買杯咖啡和一個**小麵包**。」

So here:

> **bun** = 小型單份麵包

1. **bun** = small bread roll — 小麵包；圓麵包

The core food meaning.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I went in for a coffee and a **bun**.”

「我進去買了杯咖啡和一個**小麵包**。」

Practice 2

> “She bought two fresh buns from the bakery.”

「她從麵包店買了兩個新鮮的**小麵包**。」

Practice 3

> “The buns were soft and warm.”

「那些**小麵包**又軟又暖。」

bun = 小型、單份、通常圓形的麵包

2. **bun = sweet bun / filled bun — 甜麵包；有餡小麵包**

A common contextual extension.

Practice 4

> “He ordered a cinnamon **bun**.”

「他點了一個肉桂**甜麵包**。」

Practice 5

> “The bakery sells buns filled with cream.”

「這間麵包店出售忌廉餡**小麵包**。」

bun = 可指帶甜味、香料或餡料的小型麵包

This is still the same food sense, so I would not split it further lexically.

3. **hamburger bun = 漢堡包麵包**

A common lexicalized compound.

Practice 6

> “The burger comes in a toasted ****bun****.”

「這個漢堡配烤過的****漢堡包麵包****。」

Practice 7

> “The buns are made fresh every morning.”

「那些****漢堡麵包****每天早上新鮮製作。」

****hamburger bun = 用來夾漢堡肉和配料的圓形麵包****

4. ****hot dog bun = 熱狗麵包****

Another common compound.

Practice 8

> “Put the sausage in the ****hot dog bun****.”

「把香腸放進****熱狗麵包****裡。」

Practice 9

> “The shop sells soft hot dog buns.”

「這間店出售柔軟的****熱狗麵包****。」

****hot dog bun = 長形、切開後用來夾香腸的麵包****

5. ****bun = hairstyle with hair twisted/coiled into a round shape — 髮髻 ; 髻****

A major distinct non-food meaning.

Practice 10

> “She wore her hair in a ****bun****.”

「她把頭髮盤成一個****髮髻****。」

Practice 11

> “The dancer tied her hair into a neat bun.”

「舞者把頭髮盤成整齊的****髮髻****。」

****bun — hairstyle = 把頭髮盤成圓形、固定在頭後或頭頂的髮型****

Excellent MCQ contrast with food.

6. ****hair bun = 髮髻****

A useful explicit compound.

Practice 12

> “Her ****hair bun**** was decorated with flowers.”

「她的****髮髻****用花朵裝飾。」

Practice 13

> “She pinned the bun high on her head.”

「她把****髮髻****固定在頭頂較高的位置。」

****hair bun = 圓形盤髮造型****

7. ****bun = buttock, usually plural buns (俚語) — 臀部****

A slang meaning worth recognizing, though secondary.

Practice 14

> “He fell hard on his ****buns****.”

「他重重跌坐在****屁股 / 臀部****上。」

Practice 15

> “The exercise targets the buns and legs.”

「這個運動主要鍛鍊**臀部**和**腿部**。」

buns — slang = 臀部 / 屁股

Register:

- * informal
- * slang
- * often plural

For your course, I would keep this as recognition-level rather than a core production meaning.

Important distinction: **bun** vs **bread**

You just curated **bread**.

bread

= broad food category, usually uncountable.

bun

= one small individual bread item.

> bread

> = 麵包這類食物

> a bun

> = 一個小麵包

So:

> some bread

> two buns

Important distinction: **bun** vs **roll**

bun

often:

- * round
- * soft
- * sometimes sweet
- * sometimes used around fillings

roll

broader:

a small individual bread item, often savoury.

There is a lot of regional overlap.

> bread roll

> = 小餐包

> sweet bun

> = 甜麵包

In some varieties, **bun** and **roll** may refer to very similar things.

Important distinction: **bun vs pastry**

bun

usually bread-based dough.

pastry

usually richer, fattier, often flaky or crumbly dough.

> bun

> = 小麵包

> pastry

> = 酥點 / 糕點

However, bakery categorization can vary.

Important distinction: **bun vs cake**

bun

usually bread-like, often yeast-based.

cake

usually softer, sweeter, richer batter-based baked food.

A sweet bun can be sweet like cake, but structurally it is still bread-like.

Important distinction: **bun — food vs hairstyle**

Food:

> “I bought a bun.”

= 我買了一個小麵包。

Hairstyle:

> “She wore a bun.”

= 她把頭髮盤成髮髻。

Completely different meanings.

Important distinction: **bun vs chignon**

bun

general everyday term for a round coiled hairstyle.

chignon

more formal/fashion-specific:

a low or elegant knot of hair, usually at the back of the head.

> bun = 髮髻

> chignon = 低髮髻 / 盤髮

Important distinction: **bun vs buns**

bun

singular:

- * one bread item
- * one hair bun

buns

plural:

- * several bread items
- * slang for buttocks

Context is crucial.

Important grammar note: **bun is countable**

Natural:

- > a bun
- > two buns
- > several buns

Unlike **bread**, which is usually uncountable.

So:

- > a bun 
- > a bread  usually

This is a very useful learner contrast.

Important note on polysemy depth

Bun has a relatively compact modern inventory.

The main genuinely useful senses are:

1. **small bread item**
2. **hair bun**
3. **buns = buttocks** in slang

Then the food meaning branches into common compounds such as:

- * hamburger bun
- * hot dog bun
- * cinnamon bun

We should not over-split every bakery variety into a new lexical meaning.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

- * **bun — food** = 小麵包 / 圓麵包
- * **bun — sweet/filled** = 甜麵包 / 有餡小麵包
- * **hamburger bun** = 漢堡包麵包
- * **hot dog bun** = 熱狗麵包
- * **bun — hairstyle** = 髮髻
- * **hair bun** = 髮髻
- * **buns — slang** = 臀部 / 屁股

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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bun — food	小型、單份、通常圓形的麵包
bun — sweet/filled	帶甜味、香料或餡料的小型麵包
hamburger bun	用來夾漢堡肉和配料的圓形麵包
hot dog bun	用來夾香腸的長形麵包
bun — hairstyle	把頭髮盤成圓形並固定在頭後或頭頂的髮型
buns — slang	非正式用語中的臀部 / 屁股

For your original sentence

> “At first, I just went in for a quick coffee and a **bun**...”

The exact meaning is:

**bun = Golden Crust 售賣的一個小型單份麵包，可能是原味或帶甜味，但重點是「一個小麵包」這個一般食物意思。 **

Natural translation:

> **「起初，我只是進去買一杯咖啡和一個小麵包。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

> **bun** → 小麵包

> **hamburger bun** → 漢堡包麵包

> **hot dog bun** → 熱狗麵包

> **hair in a bun** → 頭髮盤成髮髻

> **buns — slang** → 臀部

> **bread vs bun** → 麵包類食物 vs 一個可數的小麵包